

MB 537: Business and Data Leadership

Course Code: MB 537

Course Name: Business and Data Leadership

L-T-P-C: 2-0-0-2

Prerequisites: NA

Intended for: MBA & IMBA

Mutual Exclusion: NA

Approval: 59th BoA (I-MBA curriculum); course proposal approved in the 60th BoA

Preamble

This course equips business leaders to harness the power of data and AI to drive strategic success. It covers essential topics such as transforming business challenges into data-driven solutions, aligning AI with business goals, and scaling AI initiatives across organizations. Leaders will gain critical insights into data ethics, governance, and the key leadership skills required in the AI era. With real-world case studies and actionable frameworks, this course equips leaders to use data and AI as strategic assets, enabling innovation, efficiency, and sustainable growth while navigating the complexities of modern business environments.

Course Modules

- **Strategic Data and AI Thinking for Business Leaders:** Foundations of data literacy for leaders, Framing business problems into data questions, Data-informed vs data-driven decisions. Role of data in modern business strategy, Key leadership skills in the age of data, Data maturity models in organisations, Data as a strategic asset (Case). The evolution of leadership in a data and AI-driven economy, How business strategy shifts in the presence of intelligent systems, Value creation through data and machine learning. (3 hrs)
- **Business Outcomes and AI Alignment:** Leading with business outcomes; Technology, business and human values; Creating an AI business plan, Linking AI investments to revenue, retention, speed, and innovation, AI and Business Value Matrix. (5 hrs)
- **Scaling Data & AI Strategy:** From pilot to enterprise-wide transformation, Strategic AI roadmap design, Cross-functional governance & operating models, Maturity assessment tools, Funding, talent, and executive sponsorship. (5 hrs)
- **Building and Leading Data and AI Teams:** Organisational structures for data leadership, Data and AI Roles, Building cross-functional teams: analysts, engineers, product, and domain experts, Culture of experimentation vs perfectionism, RACI for data and AI ownership. (5 hrs)
- **Responsible Leadership in AI & Data Ethics, Governance and Regulations:** Lead responsibly in the algorithmic age, Fairness, accountability, transparency, explainability and privacy, creating ethical review boards, bias detection, and regulatory frameworks (GDPR, AI Act), Human oversight vs full autonomy. (6 hrs)
- **AI & Data Success Stories:** Real-life stories of companies (case studies) that have harnessed AI and Data leadership effectively to create value. (4 hrs)



Text Books

Instructor will provide a combination of reference material and cases.

Reference Books

1. Marco Iansiti and Karim R. Lakhani, *Competing in the Age of AI*, Harvard Business Review Press, 2020.
2. Robert D. Austin, *The Adventures of an IT Leader*, Harvard Business Review Press, 2016.
3. Randy Bean and Thomas H. Davenport, *Fail Fast, Learn Faster: Lessons in Data-Driven Leadership in the Age of Disruption, Big Data and AI*, Wiley, 2021.
4. Amanda Datnow and Vicki Park, *Data-Driven Leadership*, Wiley, 2014.
5. Frances Frei and Anne Morriss, *Move Fast and Fix Things: The Trusted Leader's Guide to Solving Hard Problems*, Harvard Business Review Press, 2023.
6. Jenny Dearborn and David Swanson, *The Data-Driven Leader*, Wiley, 2018.